

[GSX] Global Reflections

22 May 2026



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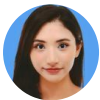
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Given Memorial Day weekend, we are sending this week's note out a day early. Will revert to normal schedule next week.

The two-and-a-half-day momo sell-off that kicked off last Friday reflects an increased openness to diversify beyond the AI complex. So, what's attractive beyond the AI leaders? The answer, throughout the war, has been our bottleneck basket (**GSCBBOTL**). But as we think about post-war life, there is building interest around upside in oversold pockets (Consumer) or forgotten laggards (Healthcare), while the debate on Software is also more balanced. Six key points:

- **Low Momo/Dual Binaries Look Appealing into Potential Inflection:**
 - US momentum is currently synonymous with the AI trade, and a substantial de-escalation catalyst could result in a Low Momo (**GSXULMOM**) **squeeze** where thematically there has been client interest in owning upside in Consumer pockets such as **GSXULOWD**. Given this trade's binary payoff, we like expressing upside via options. **A Jul26 110/120% call spread on our consumer discretionary basket (GSXUCOND) costs 1.07%, 14d, 9.3x max payout. A Jul26 108/118% call spread on GSXULOWD costs 1.28%, 18d, 7.8x max payout.**
 - De-escalation could also mean waning AI enthusiasm which has the potential to drag the broader index lower. Afterall, AI has been 6pp of the S&P 500 return in the past 6 months. Our vol structuring desk highlights dual binaries as interesting hedges on this. A 3% SPX dip and 10y yield 30bp lower scenario is possible on war ending and AI enthusiasm dissipating. What's more is that the market appears squarely focused on inflation risk, which means hedging growth

risk screens cheap. **A Sep26 dual binary SPX <97% 10YSOFR < CMS fwd -30bp costs 8.0%** (27%/32% EQ/IR indivs, -5 corr offer).

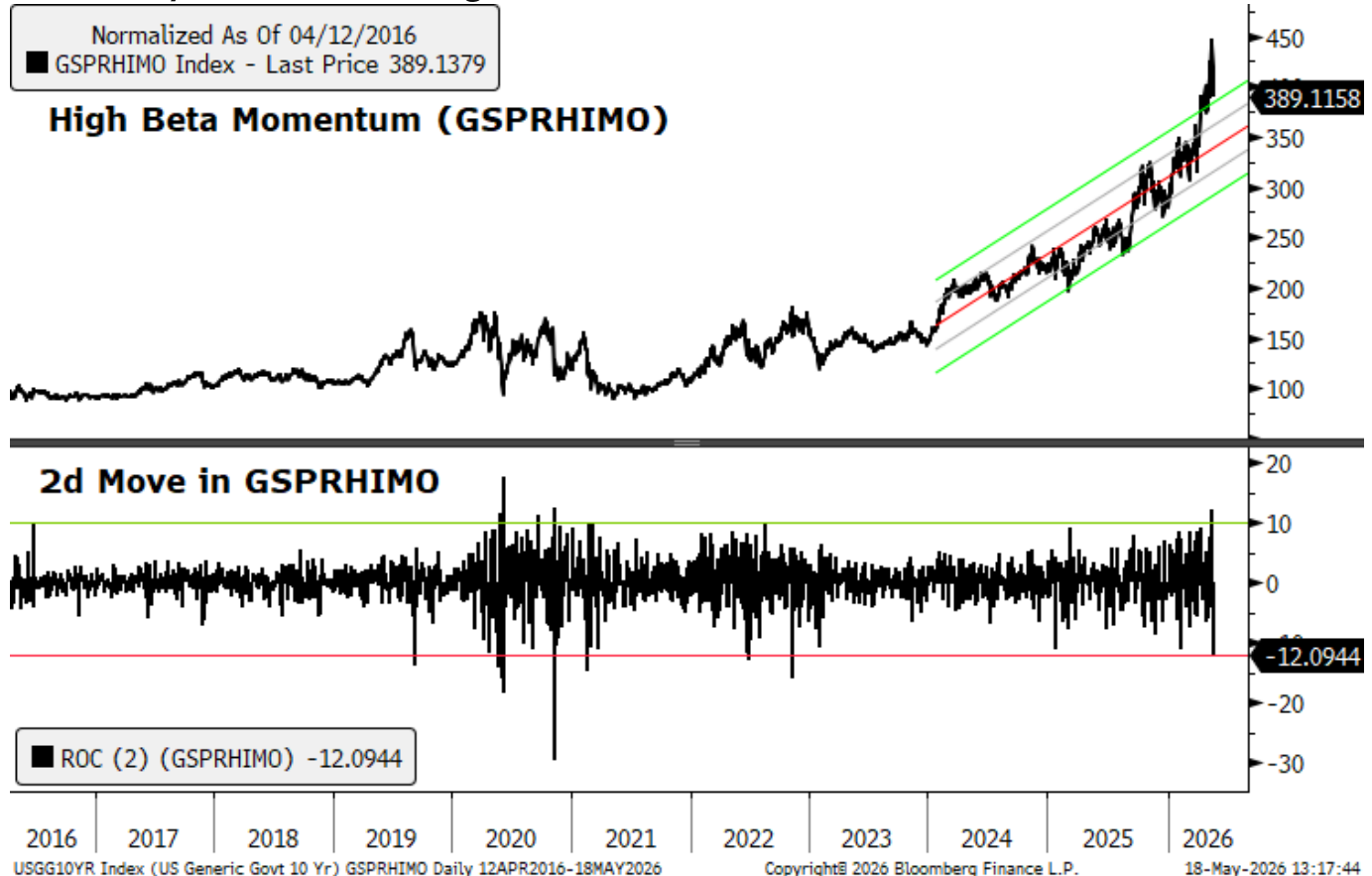
- The setup for Gold versus Oil also looks interesting in a ‘post-war’ scenario, with Gold miners and buyers naturally short oil and any potential SoH tolling likely to be USD negative. **A Sep26 dual binary GLD >107.5%, COX6 in [75 90] range currently costs 12% (32%/35% GLD/Oil indivs).**

- **Which Equities Will Higher Rates Break?** If rates stay high, there are pockets that look too rich. Our Low-Quality basket (**GSXULOWQ**) combines multiple thematic baskets with low quality characteristics, such as non-profitable tech, low-profit small-caps and companies with HY debt sensitivity. GSXULOWQ has held up relatively well versus the move in US 10Y yields. If yields don’t retrace back to pre-war levels, we see >20% relative downside in this trade. Our Non-Profitable Tech basket (**GSX1NPTC**) remains one of our most popular rates-sensitive hedges. But strong narrative momentum in secular themes can often sustain positive price performance for unprofitable companies. Our preferred rates-sensitive short is our newly launched Non-Profitable Non-Secular Tech basket (**GSCBNOPS**) which excludes euphoria-exposed names across space, satellites, quantum computing and more.
- **Healthcare is an AI-Uncorrelated Compounder:** The sector has been out of vogue for a while given persistent underperformance of Defensives versus Cyclical and a lack of significant micro catalysts (blockbuster launches, clinical trial breakthroughs, healthcare M&A). But this complex remains an AI-uncorrelated compounder which holds up strongly when AI sells off and is also a beneficiary of AI adoption (drug discovery, hospital capex etc.). We see tailwinds in Biotech given an upcoming Pharma patent cliff. Our strategic M&A basket for biotech is interesting amidst this backdrop. Life Sciences Tools should benefit from an end-market recovery as the 4Q25 sentiment swing in biopharma starts to feed through to order and earnings momentum. And growth in Biologics should drive upside across the Pharma supply chain. [Reach out](#) for more details on our Healthcare offering.
- **Ex-US Financials are an Attractive Diversifier.** Rates sensitive financials stand to benefit from higher-for-longer rates and a cyclical uplift from the war ending. While US financials are likely fine in the near-term, midterms beckon later in the year and so our preference is for ex-US exposure for now. IN Europe, we like owning our High NII Basket (**GSXEHNII**) which isolates Banks with the greatest earnings leverage to higher interest rates. Regionally, Greek Banks (**GSXEGRBK**) also screen in the High NII bucket and have the added kicker of solid loan growth and relative-value opportunity versus European peers. In Asia, the Japan Banks trade (**GSXAJMEB**) makes sense ahead of next month’s central bank meeting given latest BoJ commentary leaning towards continued hikes.
- **There is Value in Owning AI Abroad.** Market perception of what encompasses AI is broadening beyond semis and hyperscalers, and investors are seeking AI exposure beyond US borders. Asia’s AI trades have had a phenomenal run so far this year but last week’s momo sell-off created a rare ‘buy the dip’ opportunity in some of these themes. Our favorite Asia AI expressions are the AI bottleneck trade (**GSXABOTL**)

and Taiwan AI Capex basket ([GSXATAIH](#)) both of which have sold off close to ~3% in the last week.

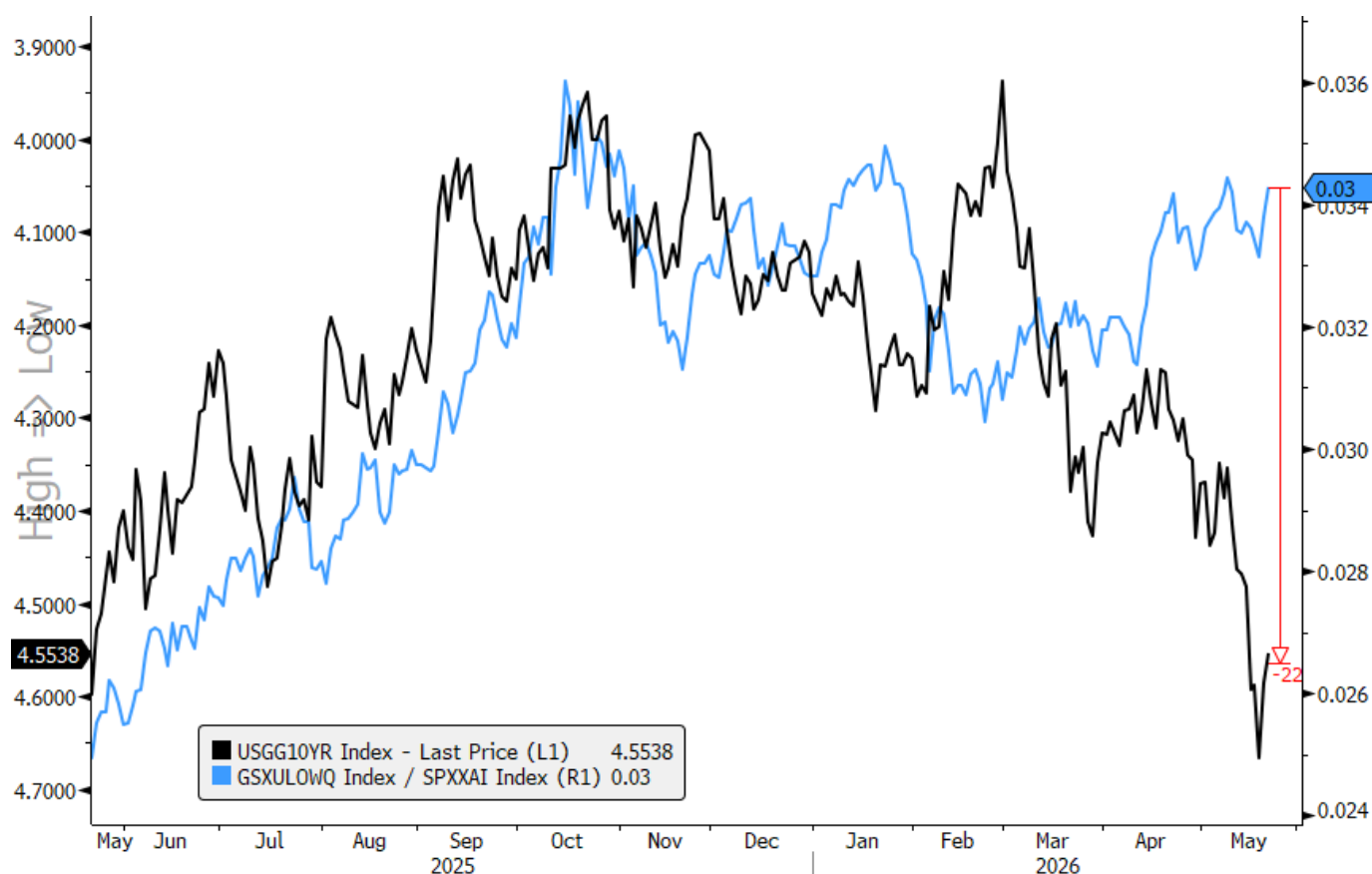
- **Is Defense Making a Comeback?** Global defense spending is going up and we are heading into a busier catalyst period with the [Eurosummit](#) and [NATO](#) summits in June and July. At the same time, AI proliferation is driving investment in cybersecurity, drones, and new defense. Post a sharp YTD valuation reset and positioning clean-up, the European Defense ([GSSBDEF](#)) trade is making a comeback, and we see at least another 10% upside for YTD price performance to realign with EPS revisions. Valuation wise, a re-rating back to last year's median multiple would imply a 20%+ uplift (23x vs. 29x P/E). And while perception is that European defense lacks higher-tech exposure relative to the US and Asia, the midcap space offers purer-play New Defense exposure via [GSXENDEF](#). The US Defense trade ([GSXUDFNS](#)) has also cheapened, with most of the sell-off being beta-driven while post-war inventory restock would imply earnings upgrades.

Last Friday kicked off the largest consecutive Momo drawdown since 2022



Source: Goldman Sachs FICC & Equities, Bloomberg; past performance is not indicative of future returns; as of May 2026

US Low Quality Stocks ([GSXULOWQ](#)) have held up despite the 10Y move; we see 20% relative downside in a higher-for-longer rates environment



GSXULOWQ Index (GS US Low Quality) Daily 21MAY2025-21MAY2026

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Source: Goldman Sachs FICC & Equities, Bloomberg, as of 21 May 2026; past performance is not indicative of future results

Most pockets of US Healthcare display negative excess correlation to AI

Ticker	Ticker	Excess Correlation to AI
US HC CROs	GSHLCCRO	-28%
US HC IT & Digital Disruptive Health	GSHLCITD	-27%
US HC Medtech & Tools	GSHLCMDT	-26%
US HC Medtech	GSHLCMTS	-21%
US HC Life Sciences Tools & Diagnostics	GSHLCLST	-21%
US HC Services	GSHLCSER	-18%
US HC GLP Risk	GSHLCGLP	-14%
US HC Artificial Intelligence	GSHLCAIP	-13%
US HC Growth Medtech	GSHLCMED	-10%
US HC Sector	GSXUHLTH	-10%
US HC Pharma Supply Chain	GSHLCPSC	-7%
US HC Elective Procedures	GSHLCELE	-1%
US HC Genomics	GSHLCGMC	3%
US HC Animal Health	GSHLCANH	4%
US HC Managed Care	GSHLCMCR	4%
US HC Hospitals & Providers	GSHLCHSP	6%
US HC Dental & Vision Care	GSHLCDVC	8%
US HC Large Cap Pharma	GSHLCLCP	16%

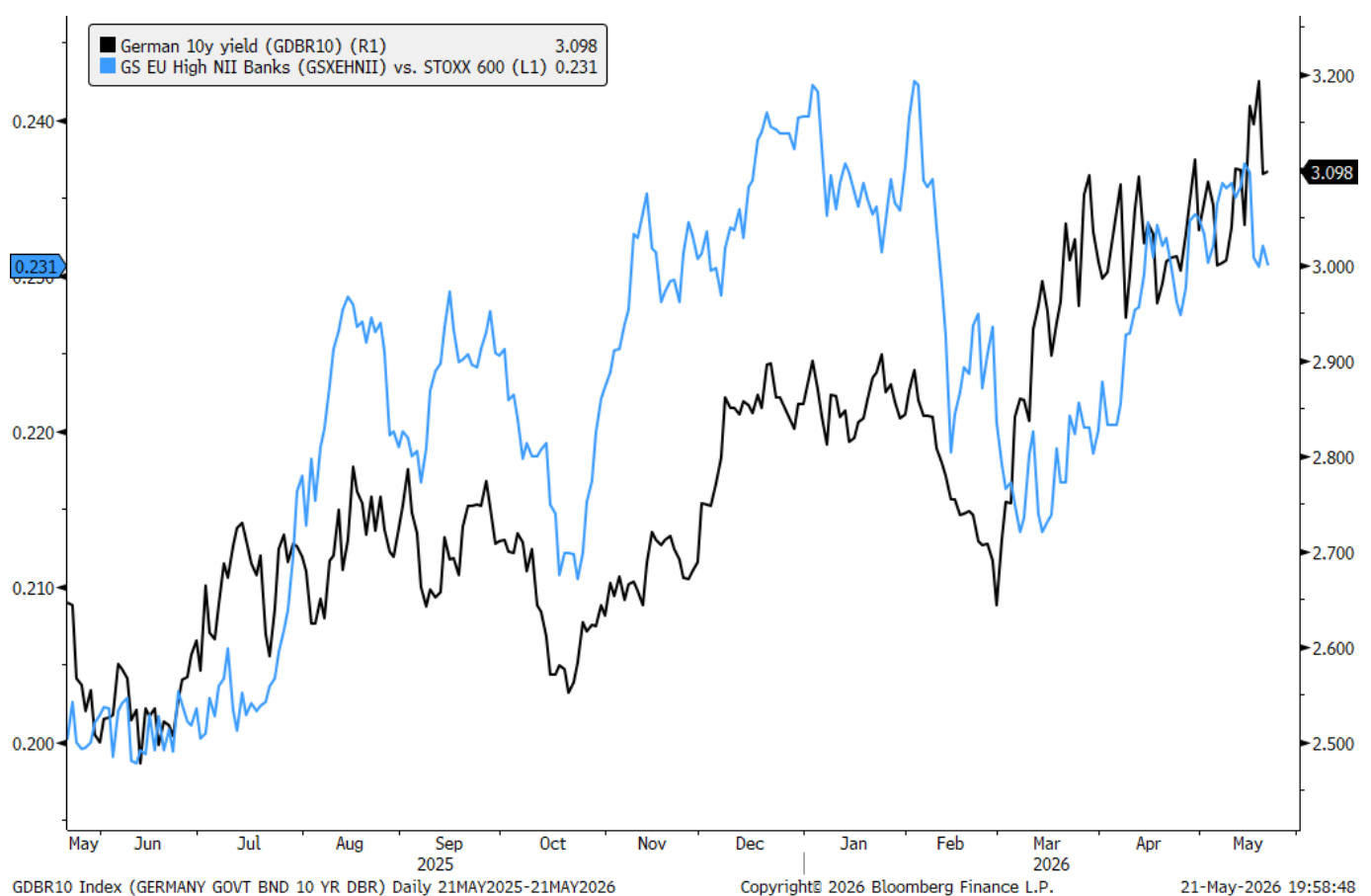
Source: Goldman Sachs FICC & Equities, Bloomberg, as of 21 May 2026; past performance is not indicative of future results

For investors looking to a broader universe, Financials, Geopolitical Risk & Communications are also highly negatively correlated to AI

Name	RIC	3m excess Corr to AI	Momentum Loading
AI at Risk	GSTMTAIR	-90%	-1.6
High Beta 12M Losers	GSXULMOM	-84%	-2.1
GS US Expensive Software	GSXUSF8X	-69%	-1.1
Financials	GSXUFINA	-48%	-0.3
SMid-Cap AI Productivity	GSXUSPRO	-39%	-0.2
US M&A Candidates	GSCBMNAT	-35%	-0.4
Geopolitical Risk	GSXUGEOP	-34%	0.2
Communications	GSXUCOMS	-31%	-0.2
Oil	GSENOILB	-30%	0.1
Energy	GSXUENRG	-29%	0.1
Non Secular Non Profitable	GSCBNOPS	-28%	-0.5
Total Cash Return	GSTHCASH	-24%	-0.2
MAHA Risk (Health Regulation Risk)	GSXUMAHA	-24%	-0.7
Low Income Discretionary	GSXULOWD	-23%	-0.3
Nat Gas	GSENNATG	-23%	-0.2
Low Quality Themes	GSXULOWQ	-22%	-0.4
Expensive Defensives	GSXUEDEF	-19%	-0.4
Alternative Asset Managers	GSFINALT	-18%	-1.0
Defense Spending	GSXUDFNS	-17%	-0.2
Staples	GSXUSTAP	-16%	-0.7
REITs	GSXURLST	-11%	-0.4
Liquid Regional Banks	GSCBRGBK	-11%	-0.1
Health Care	GSXUHLTH	-10%	-0.6
GS Liquid IPO Basket	GSXULIPO	-10%	-0.7
GS US Defensives	GSXUDEFS	-10%	-0.4
GSXURETL	GSXURETL	-7%	-0.2
AI Productivity	GSXUPROD	-6%	0.0
Bond Proxies	GSXUBOND	-5%	-0.5
Discretionary	GSXUCOND	2%	-0.4
Utilities	GSXUUTIL	2%	-0.2
High European Sales Exposure	GSXUEURO	6%	-0.2
Oil Consumers	GSXUOILX	23%	-0.5
GS HY Debt Sensitivity	GSXUDEBT	24%	0.1
GS Liquid Most Short	GSXUMSAL	24%	-0.1
Memes	GSXUMEME	25%	0.3
De-Regulation Beneficiaries	GSXUDREG	25%	0.1

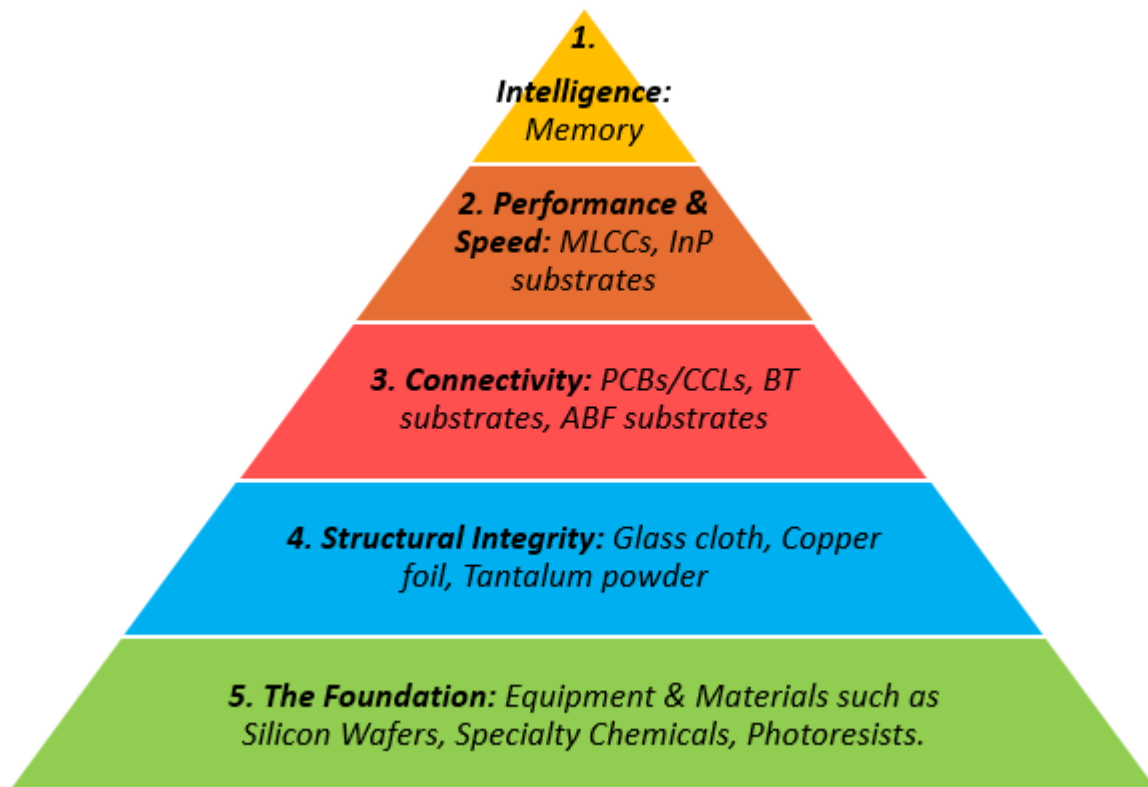
Source: Goldman Sachs FICC & Equities, Bloomberg, as of 21 May 2026; past performance is not indicative of future results

EU Banks stand to benefit from higher rates and post-war cyclical upside



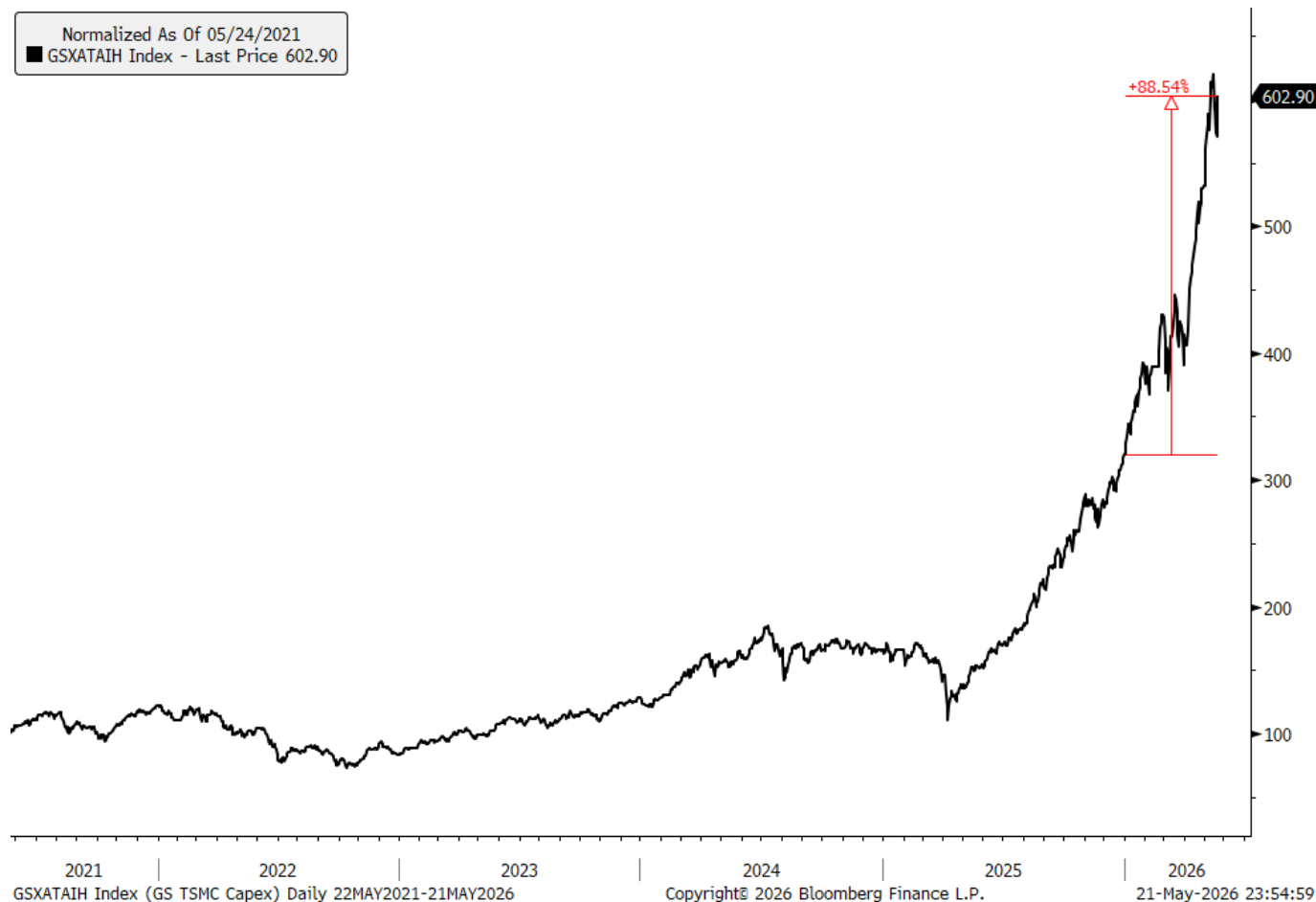
Source: Goldman Sachs FICC & Equities, Bloomberg, as of 21 May 2026; past performance is not indicative of future results

While diversifying out of AI makes sense, owning AI abroad is also attractive. [GSXABOTL](#) provides exposure to the most critical parts of AI infra where supply tightness drives pricing power



Source: GS Custom Baskets as of 25th March 2026

Taiwan AI Capex ([GSXATAIH](#)) has been a winning theme; last week's pullback created a rare 'buy the dip' moment



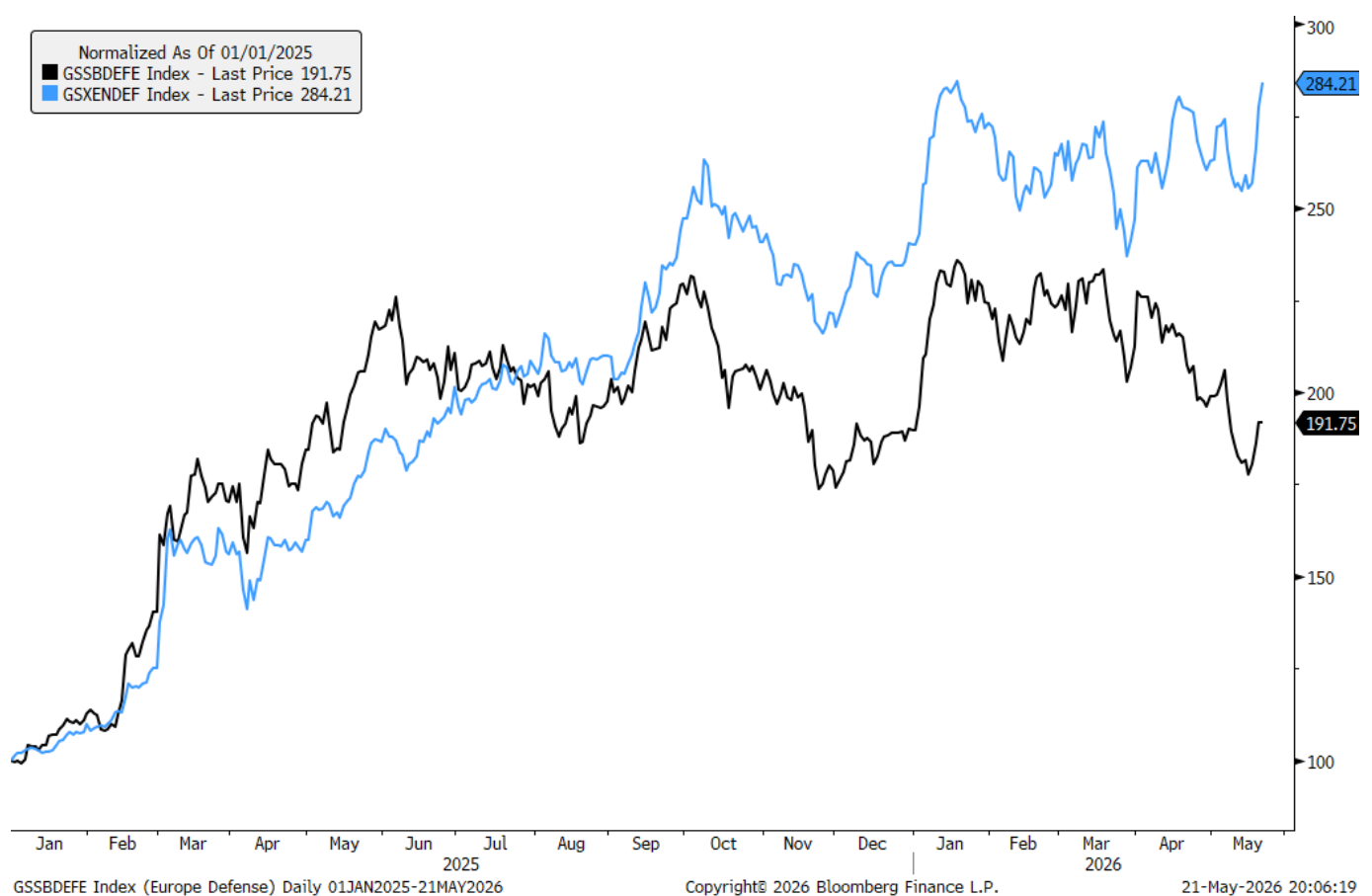
Source: Goldman Sachs FICC & Equities, Bloomberg, as of 21 May 2026; past performance is not indicative of future results

European Defense (**GSSBDEFE**) valuation has compressed significantly; a re-rating back to last year's median multiple implies 20%+ upside



Source: Goldman Sachs FICC & Equities, Marquee Plottool Pro, as of 21 May 2026; past performance is not indicative of future results

The proliferation of higher-tech defense systems is driving demand for pure-play 'New Defense' exposure (**GSXENDEF**)



Source: Goldman Sachs FICC & Equities, Bloomberg, as of 21 May 2026; past performance is not indicative of future results

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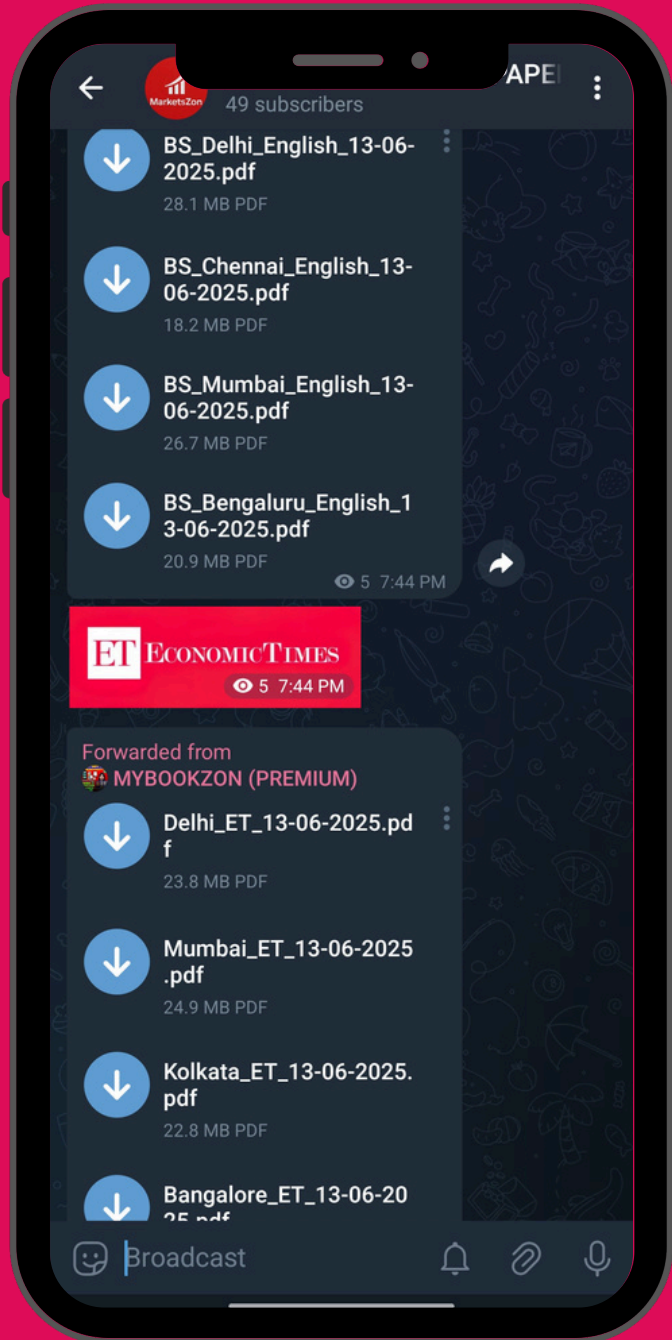
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